the stopping power of the sea between it and China but also because of its economic and military weakness relative to its giant East Asian neighbour. Taking a broader view of the Kautilyan strategic framework, the US and its Western friends would be potential allies of India: they could open up a diplomatic and strategic front against China. The US, with its capabilities, more than any other power is consequential for India. Not surprisingly, India views America increasingly as an ally against China.

The *Arthashastra* is suggestive of another potential resource for India: dharma. From India's point of view, the spread of dharma to China might alter the relationship. If China were to adopt a dharmic polity and a dharmic view of international relations in which righteous conduct governs both domestic and external policy, India and China could find a way to live together in peace as two morally guided neighbours. Golwalkar has written that India could spread dharmic values peacefully. While Kautilya sees the vijigisu spreading dharmic values as it expands and conquers, the RSS supremo envisages the willing adoption of dharma based on the appeal of the moral codes themselves as also India's exemplary dharmic behaviour.[95] An India that is consistently, even obstinately, dharmic might manage China by means of non-strategic instruments. Indian policy towards China since 1949 certainly could be said to have attempted to resolve differences by invoking legal and moral codes.

How does China appear in India's modern cosmopolitan worldview? India and China might have quarrels over territory and their standing in the world, but more important than these mundane, conventional matters is the possibility of a dialogue on values and norms, on larger questions about human existence and organization. For Vivekananda, Tagore, and Gandhi, modern (Western) industrialism has impoverished the spiritual life of humanity. Yet that transcendent life is still available to us and could unite India and China – not in the political sense of merging territories and governments but rather in the quest for a more wholesome, just, and sustainable existence for humankind.

India and China, in this view, appear as co-leaders of a possible pan-Asianism. Important to this view is the notion of a 'Chindia' that is *for* the